ANKUR SHEEL

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SUMMARY

I am a software developer who strives to help people become more efficient and productive. My background is a mix of fast-paced startup environments and the structured complexity of large-scale enterprises. In my previous life, I have worked as a game developer. I enjoy building tools which help reduce the time taken by my team members to complete tasks as well as making code maintainable by using refactoring techniques and adding test coverage. I take an active interest in improving processes to benefit my team members. I'm usually building my own side projects and blogging about whatever new tech I've picked up.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Woolworths (NZ) - Software Engineer

Auckland, New Zealand | May 2026 - Present
Technology: C#, TypeScript, React

- Implemented features for the website to enhance user engagement and experience.

Atlassian - Software Engineer

Remote (Auckland) | Nov 2022 - Mar 2026
Technology: Java, TypeScript, React

- I successfully designed and delivered a solution to increase the reliability of Issue Create by enabling idempotent retries. The design was future-proof for adjacent use cases and other teams were able to onboard without much effort.
- I inherited a partially complete work breakdown for optimizing attachments loading in Jira. I completed the work breakdown and took full ownership. Over a period of 6 months, I delivered a 90ms improvement at P90. This included implementing both backend and frontend solutions.
- I proposed a solution and resolved an issue where customers were not able to rename projects with a large number of issues by breaking the update into batches and moving it to a background task.
- I successfully investigated and resolved a 3-year-old customer problem related to worklog inconsistencies
- I introduced a new **FeatureFlagWillMakeThisObsolete** annotation to help with Feature Flag cleanups. This annotation was adopted by other teams.
- I created an IntelliJ plugin to speed by the cleaning up of Feature flags by automating the deletion of obsolete code behind a Feature Flag.
- I wrote a blog post highlighting the benefits of small commits in PR's which was well received by the organization and drove a lot of fruitful discussions.

- I successfully drove productivity-enhancing process changes within the team, including improvements in story pointing, sprint planning, and implementing a async rollout process
- Built a Forge app reducing feature-flag rollout preparation from 20 minutes to 5 minutes.
- Mentored junior engineers.

First AML - Senior Software Engineer

Auckland, New Zealand | Nov 2019 - Oct 2022
Technology: C#, GraphQL

- I joined First AML as the 2nd Backend Engineer after they raised a Seed Round. By the time I left, the Product and Engineering team had grown to more than 30 people.
- I developed a solution to automate the running of identity verifications (with a 3rd party provider). This reduced the time analysts spent verifying an individual from 5+ minutes to less than 1 minute.
- I designed and implemented a solution for copying complex entity structures across cases. This directly impacted analyst efficiency by reducing the time they spent building the entity structure and copying over information from 20+ minutes to a few seconds.
- I added email integrations to power the forms sent to end users. I also created a slack integration to notify analysts if the email could not be sent because of a bounce/complaint error.
- As part of a team, I did a lot of the integration changes to integrate with a new data provider so that we could expand into new markets.
- As part of a team, I worked on client and user management. This work contained some exciting concepts around storing secrets per client but not exposing them on the API. It also removed the need for anyone to directly access the production database to create users and clients.
- I built a Feature flag system for the backend, which helped merge small PRs to the production branch. I created an open-source tool to easily modify feature flag files.
- I migrated the backend from Graphql.Net to HotChocolate and set up conventions for the API.
- I ran introductory sessions for Insomnia and Feature Flags for people who were new to those concepts.
- I started a fortnightly retrospective and lunch-n-learn for the product and engineering team.
- I introduced No Meeting Thursdays and stress-free code reviews to improve developer. I wrote blog posts around this which helped attract talent and explain the culture to new starters.

Pushpay - Software Developer

Auckland, New Zealand | Jul 2018 – Nov 2019
Technology: C#, GraphQL React

- I was the feature lead for various features and worked on several features and bug fixes.
- I built a Feature Flag system for the new platform for donor development.
- I devised a strategy and rollout plan to add a Content Security policy to the website.
- I created a Postman collection which enabled QA to test ajax endpoints protected against Cross-Site Request Forgery attacks. I also wrote a blog post about it.

Vista Entertainment Solutions - Software Developer

Auckland, New Zealand | Apr 2016 – Jun 2018

Technology: C#, VisualBasic

- I worked on several features and bug fixes to enhance the POS (Point of Sale) system.
- I helped set up the basic bindings for Specflow for our unit/feature tests. This enabled the QA team to help write the tests.
- I introduced style and static analyzers to ensure that the team maintained the coding standards.
- I reduced the number of warnings (by more than 1500) while continuously refactoring the legacy code to make it more readable and maintainable.
- I initiated an increase in intra-team communication across the cohort, which helped us avoid duplicated efforts and keep other members apprised of changes and best practices.
- I emphasized using unit tests over system tests to have a faster feedback loop.

Gameloft (New Zealand) – Mid Level Programmer

Auckland, New Zealand | Jun 2014 – Jan 2016
Technology: C#, VisualBasic

- I added gameplay features in various games.
- I was responsible for planning, estimating and delegating AI tasks. I also conducted an AI
- masterclass for the whole studio, which was well-received by developers and designers.
- I created a tool which allowed the Game Economy designers to see their changes (locally) in the game without requiring developer help or pushing their changes to the server.
- I added support to hot load localisation files to reduce the turnaround time for localisation-related tasks. I also added support to display multiple fonts in the same string and made various enhancements to the tool to enable rendering text in Arabic.
- I automated the creation of QA submission builds to test the game on IOS devices.
- I modified the premake script to reduce the time spent on static analysis and validation from
- upwards of 5 minutes to a few seconds. This enabled us to validate the code every time we built the solution.

Earlier Career (2005–2014)

Knowledge Adventure India Private Ltd, BlueGiant Interactive Private Ltd, Trine Game Studios, Dhruva Interactive, Perot Systems (India)

NOTABLE PERSONAL PROJECTS

- Wordxplorer: Wordle-style educational game for children built with Unity and C#, published on the App Store and Google Play.
- xUnitHelpers: helper library that simplifies writing tests with xUnit 2.
- FeatureFlagHelper: CLI tool for modifying feature flag JSON files across multiple environments.
- StatiqHelpers: wrapper around Statiq.Web to build my static websites.

You can find more projects at ***https://www.ankursheel.com/cv***

EDUCATION

Master of Science, Computer Science - University of Southern California, Los Angeles, USA
Bachelor of Science, Computer Science and Engineering - Manipal Institute of Technology, Manipal, India